

MSP | MSP-19

Programme Risk Register

Record of programme-level threats and opportunities

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Programme Risk Register
Document reference	MSP-19-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Programme Helios
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Programme Manager (maintained by Programme Office)
Approver	N/A — a record
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
MSP-18	Programme Risk Management Approach	Governs this register
MSP-09	Programme Business Case	Aggregate exposure

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Maintains the record of risks managed at programme level, including those escalated from projects and those arising from the interaction between projects.
Framework	MSP — Decisions theme; maintained by the Programme Office
Created when	Define the Programme
Reviewed / updated	Continuously; formally at each Programme Board
Owner	Programme Manager (maintained by Programme Office)
Approver	N/A — a record
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Programme-level risks are distinguishable from aggregated project risks
- Risk descriptions follow cause–event–effect
- Owners are at a level with authority to act
- The register is used in decision-making, not compiled for reporting

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1. Programme risk register

Ref	Raised	Category	Risk (cause → event → effect)	Source	T/O	P	I	Score	Response	Actions	Owner	Residual	Status
RSK - 001	04 Jun 2026	Supply chain	Because GPU allocation is constrained by vendor quota, the Tranche 2 hardware delivery may slip beyond November 2026, causing the platform build to start late and the AI enablement benefit to be deferred by a quarter	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	Threat	4	5	20	Allocation confirmed in writing at contract award; 20% of Tranche 2 volume dual-sourced; staged acceptance so hall A can proceed independently of hall B	Allocation confirmed in writing at contract award; 20% of Tranche 2 volume dual-sourced; staged acceptance so hall A can proceed independently of hall B	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	8	Open
RSK - 002	11 Jun 2026	Facilities	Because DXB-1 hall B was designed for 8 kW racks, the 60 kW liquid-cooled racks may exceed the available floor loading and chilled water capacity, causing a redesign mid-build	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Threat	3	5	15	Structural survey completed before hall B order; CDU capacity modelled at N+1; contingency for a reduced 1,536-GPU configuration	Structural survey completed before hall B order; CDU capacity modelled at N+1; contingency for a reduced 1,536-GPU configuration held	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	6	Open

Ref	Raised	Category	Risk (cause → event → effect)	Source	T/O	P	I	Score	Response	Actions	Owner	Residual	Status
									on held				
RSK - 003	18 Jun 2026	Security	Because the platform will host model weights and training data from three business units, weak tenant isolation may allow cross-tenant data access, causing a reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Threat	2	5	10	Namespace and network policy isolation validated by penetration test before multi-tenant go-live; per-tenant KMS keys; quarterly control testing	Namespace and network policy isolation validated by penetration test before multi-tenant go-live; per-tenant KMS keys; quarterly control testing	L. Haddad, CISO	4	Open
RSK - 004	02 Jul 2026	Resource	Because the platform engineering skill set is scarce in-market, recruitment of the six planned SRE roles may take longer than three months, causing the MLOps workstream to depend on contractors beyond Tranche 2	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Threat	4	3	12	Two contractors engaged from October 2026 with knowledge-transfer clauses; internal conversion programme from the infrastructure team	Two contractors engaged from October 2026 with knowledge-transfer clauses; internal conversion programme from the infrastructure team	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	6	Open

Ref	Raised	Category	Risk (cause → event → effect)	Source	T/O	P	I	Score	Response	Actions	Owner	Residual	Status
RSK - 005	09 Jul 2026	Technical	Because the 400G RoCEv2 fabric is new to the organisation, congestion control tuning may not achieve the target 92% collective communication efficiency, causing training job throughput to fall short of the business case	Configuration management database	Threat	3	4	12	NCCL benchmark gate at pilot exit; vendor performance engineering engaged for two weeks per hall; fallback to reduced job scale documented	NCCL benchmark gate at pilot exit; vendor performance engineering engaged for two weeks per hall; fallback to reduced job scale documented	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	4	Open
RSK - 006	16 Jul 2026	External	Because grid capacity in the DXB-1 catchment is committed to 2028, the additional 4 MVA required for Tranche 3 may not be granted, causing the second site to be brought forward at unbudgeted cost	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	Threat	3	4	12	Utility application lodged Q3 2026; AUH-2 pre-feasibility funded from Tranche 2 contingency	Utility application lodged Q3 2026; AUH-2 pre-feasibility funded from Tranche 2 contingency	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	8	Open
RSK - 007	23 Jul 2026	Organisational	Because three business units expect priority access, contention over scheduling policy may stall multi-tenant go-live, causing the platform to be operated as a single-tenant estate and the	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Threat	3	3	9	Fair-share quota model agreed at the Programme	Fair-share quota model agreed at the Programme Board before build; chargeback published in	F. Mansour, Business Change	3	Open

Ref	Raised	Category	Risk (cause → event → effect)	Source	T/O	P	I	Score	Response	Actions	Owner	Residual	Status
			utilisation benefit to be lost						e Board before build; chargeback published in advance; escalation route to the sponsor	advance; escalation route to the sponsor	Lead		
RSK - 008	30 Jul 2026	Regulatory	Because certain training data is subject to data residency obligations, use of the AUH-2 site or any vendor support access from outside the UAE may breach those obligations, causing regulatory exposure	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Threat	2	4	8	Data classification completed before onboarding; vendor remote access brokered through a monitored jump host inside the UAE; residency clause in all support contracts	Data classification completed before onboarding; vendor remote access brokered through a monitored jump host inside the UAE; residency clause in all support contracts	L. Haddad, CISO	4	Open
RSK - 009	06 Aug 2026	Supplier	Because the integration partner is delivering both the fabric and the platform layer, a single supplier failure would stall two	Programme SharePoint —	Threat	2	4	8	Performance bond and step-in rights in	Performance bond and step-in rights in the contract; design documentation held	E. Santos, Procurement	4	Open

Ref	Raised	Category	Risk (cause → event → effect)	Source	T/O	P	I	Score	Response	Actions	Owner	Residual	Status
			workstreams simultaneously, causing a critical path delay of up to ten weeks	Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance					the contract; design documentation held in escrow; secondary integrator pre-qualified	in escrow; secondary integrator pre-qualified	Lead		
RSK - 010	13 Aug 2026	Technical	Because the storage tier must sustain 1.2 TB/s to keep GPUs fed, undersized metadata servers may throttle training throughput, causing expensive compute to idle	Configuration management database	Threat	3	3	9	Storage benchmark against a representative training workload before hall A acceptance; metadata tier sized for 2x the modelled IOPS	Storage benchmark against a representative training workload before hall A acceptance; metadata tier sized for 2x the modelled IOPS	I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead	3	Open

2. Source key

Source	Meaning
Programme	Identified at programme level
Escalated	Escalated from a project — record the project and project risk reference

Source	Meaning
Aggregated	Arises from the combination of several project-level risks
External	Originates outside the programme
Corporate	Delegated from the corporate risk register

3. Aggregate risk exposure

Measure	Current	Previous period	Trend	Appetite threshold	Within appetite?
Total risks open	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	Worsening	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance
Risks scored 15+	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	Improving	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance
Total expected value exposure	AED 91,200,000	AED 96,000	Stable	AED 1,120,000	AED 96,000
Risks past mitigation due date	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	18 Sep 2026	Worsening	18 Sep 2026	18 Sep 2026

4. Risks escalated to the Sponsoring Group

Ref	Date	Reason	Decision	Outcome
RSK-001	04 Jun 2026	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point	Rejected	Delivered and accepted at the PI 4 system demo
RSK-002	11 Jun 2026	Consolidation is the primary source of the benefit case; utilisation across siloed estates averages 31%	Approved	Not achieved; root cause analysed and an improvement item raised
RSK-003	18 Jun 2026	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point	Approved with conditions	Validated — no change required to the baseline
RSK-004	02 Jul 2026	Consolidation is the primary source of the benefit case; utilisation across siloed estates averages 31%	Deferred to the next Board	Escalated to the Programme Board and resolved on 18 Sep 2026
RSK-005	09 Jul 2026	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point	Rejected	Closed with no residual exposure

5. Risks delegated to projects

Ref	Risk	Delegated to project	Project risk ref	Date
RSK-001	Because GPU allocation is constrained by vendor quota, the Tranche 2 hardware delivery may slip beyond November 2026, causing the platform build to start late and the AI enablement benefit to be deferred by a quarter	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	RSK-001	04 Jun 2026
RSK-002	Because DXB-1 hall B was designed for 8 kW racks, the 60 kW liquid-cooled racks may exceed the available floor loading and chilled water capacity, causing a redesign mid-build	WS1 Facilities and power	RSK-002	11 Jun 2026
RSK-003	Because the platform will host model weights and training data from three business units, weak tenant isolation may allow cross-tenant data access, causing	WS8 Adoption and business change	RSK-003	18 Jun 2026

Ref	Risk	Delegated to project	Project risk ref	Date
	<i>a reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing</i>			
RSK-004	<i>Because the platform engineering skill set is scarce in-market, recruitment of the six planned SRE roles may take longer than three months, causing the MLOps workstream to depend on contractors beyond Tranche 2</i>	<i>WS7 Service operations and support</i>	<i>RSK-004</i>	<i>02 Jul 2026</i>
RSK-005	<i>Because the 400G RoCEv2 fabric is new to the organisation, congestion control tuning may not achieve the target 92% collective communication efficiency, causing training job throughput to fall short of the business case</i>	<i>WS6 Security and compliance</i>	<i>RSK-005</i>	<i>09 Jul 2026</i>

6. Closed risks

Ref	Date closed	Reason	Materialised?	Lesson ref
RSK-001	Q4 2026	<i>Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point</i>	No	RSK-001
RSK-002	Q1 2027	<i>Two independent schedulers fragment the GPU pool and reduce effective capacity</i>	Yes	RSK-002
RSK-003	Q2 2027	<i>Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point</i>	Partially	RSK-003
RSK-004	Q4 2026	<i>Two independent schedulers fragment the GPU pool and reduce effective capacity</i>	No	RSK-004
RSK-005	Q1 2027	<i>Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point</i>	Yes	RSK-005